Gniewomir Świechowski

- English—C1, Polish—Native
- Cracow, Poland
- CET/CEST, UTC +1/UTC +2
- Remote or hybrid in Cracow
- B2B contracts preferred over employment
- Most up-to-date version of the CV is available as a webpage.
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- Blog
- GitHub
- LinkedIn
- Quora answers

Executive Summary

- Backend/Full-Stack Engineer
- Senior, taken lead when needed - but not a manager
- What & Why, before How
- ~15 years of commercial experience
  - (stack) TypeScript/Node/NestJS/PostgreSQL
  - (previously) React/Redux/Saga/Storybook
  - (previously) Python/Django/PostgreSQL
  - (previously) PHP/Symfony/Laravel/MySQL
  - (previously) PHP/WordPress/JS/HTML/CSS
  - (toolbox) Shell scripting
  - (toolbox) TDD/BDD/DDD etc.
  - (toolbox) Docker/Terraform/Ansible etc.
  - (toolbox) AWS/Azure/DigitalOcean etc.
  - (toolbox) Anthropic, OpenAI and Google Coding LLMs

Overview

- I'm a generalist with 15 years of experience and focus on backend, domain modeling & efficient testing for the last few years.
- During my career, I've dived into Frontend, DevOps and even Security - rarely an expert, but I always know where to look.
- Taken lead if needed, but while I enjoy sharing knowledge, I'm not good at, nor do I enjoy, the management part of it.
- Worked mostly in agile teams using different interpretations of Scrum or rarely as a one-man fire-fighting team.
- I'm used to working in international teams and English-only communication.

Who am I as a professional

- I tend to err on the side of quality as maintenance & enhancements are estimated to cost three times as much as building the solution in the first place. Half of it is spent on understanding what to change.
- I trust research proving that development speed is a function of quality in any non-trivial code-base.
- I'm a big fan of negative-space/defensive programming & always-valid domain model. Bugs that were not persisted and propagated to vendors are those that we do not have to explain to customers.
- Both humans & LLMs seem to benefit from sticking to domain vocabulary and natural-language-like syntax in code.
- I believe automated tests to be the best form of documentation - kept up to date hourly by each CI pipeline.
- A solution should not be simpler than the solved problem, but from my experience - we tend to choose overly complex solutions for relatively simple (solved 100s of times) technical problems and oversimplify modeling of domain/business ones.
- I strongly dislike industry "cargo cults" & "silver bullets". This is how businesses get bad cases of drug-resistant microservices or develop no-code/low-code platform developer addiction.
- Using current "AI" tooling has proven to me that they can be an amazing help - regardless of their fundamental limitations, but as the common truism goes - "it is a multiplier" - for both a user's good and bad habits. Not the "silver bullet" that was promised.

Who am I as a person

- I believe in Paul Saffo's "Strong Opinions, Weakly Held" mental framework — to my brain, sticking to it comes naturally.
- Bottom-up thinker - I tend to gather facts, find patterns, then plan & act. Skipping the first two is the root of all evil.
- I tend to overexplain - I consider laying all the facts before making commitments a courtesy.
- I systematically build a library of reportage published by "Czarne" and sci-fi from the 80s.
- I lift heavy. Gym is the best stress management tool I've ever tried.

Experience

Technology Summary

For the convenience of automated CV scanning tools.

Concepts

- **Domain-Driven Design**
- **Layered/Hexagonal Architecture**
- **Modular Monolith**
- **Microservices**
- **CQRS, Events, Queues**
- **OOP, FP**
- **TDD/BDD**
- **SOLID**

Languages, Runtimes

- **TypeScript**: ~5 years
- **JavaScript**: ~13 years
- **Node.js**: ~6 years
- **Python**: ~1 year
- **PHP**: ~14 years
- **Shell**: ~4 years

Frameworks, Platforms & APIs

- **NestJS/Express**: ~4 years
- **Symfony**: ~4.5 years
- **Laravel**: ~2 years
- **Django**: ~1 year
- **WordPress**: ~8 years
- **GraphQL**: ~3 years
- **REST**: ~10 years
- **SOAP**: ~2.5 years
- **Salesforce**: ~2 years

DevOps, CI/CD, Cloud & Tooling

- **AWS**: ~2 years
- **Azure**: ~2 years
- **Digital Ocean**: ~4 years
- **Docker**: ~5 years
- **Vagrant**: ~5 years
- **Terraform**: ~2 years
- **Ansible**: ~2 years
- **Jenkins**: ~2 years
- **Kafka**: ~1 year

Databases & ORMs

- **PostgreSQL**: ~9 years
- **Redis**: ~3 years
- **MySQL**: ~6 years
- **Doctrine**: ~4.5 years
- **Eloquent ORM**: ~2 years
- **TypeORM**: ~3 years
- **Sequelize**: ~2 years
- **Prisma**: ~1 year

Frontend Technologies

- **React, Storybook**: ~4 years
- **JSS, Styled Components**: ~4 years
- **Redux**: ~2 years
- **SASS/LESS**: ~7 years
- **Vanilla CSS/HTML**: ~14 years

Prior Contracts

Pragmatic Coders **Software House, PL**

Senior Software Engineer **hybrid, from 10-2025**

Legacy rescue project for Abu Dhabi-based real-estate management SAAS with fixed budget, with the aim to improve the state of the application to the point it would pass investors' technical due diligence.

- Configuration management for the whole application
- Observability/telemetry & debugging tools for event-driven part of application
- Proper startup/shutdown process for application
- Proper authentication/authorization
- Rate-limiting
- Migration of audit trails & solving the issue that led to uncontrolled growth of stored data
- Limited memory leaks to a manageable level
- Knowledge-sharing with client employees

TypeScript K8 Azure Node Express PostgreSQL Redis

Point of contact for references: Dominik Króliczek, Team Lead

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SwingDev/Hippo Insurance **NYSE: HIPPO, insurance, USA**

Software engineer **remote, from 07-2023 to 07-2025**

Part of Agent Enablement and Underwriting teams.

- Led a large data migration project aimed at filling the gaps in our lead data in Salesforce, involving fuzzy matching 100s of thousands of entries from our data lake to Salesforce without any reliable common keys. The achieved project goal was to increase throughput of lean customer support and sales teams, which needed to fill those gaps manually before using tools external to their typical process.
- Architected redesign of Underwriting Domain to provide observability of our automated decision-making process and speed up introducing new products and markets.
- Partook in smaller projects aimed at improving the productivity of our sales agents.

Microservices TypeScript Node NestJS REST+OpenAPI PostgreSQL GraphQL Salesforce SQS

Point of contact for references: Krystian Koper & Andrew Paulson, Engineering Managers

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Speychain ltd **startup, marketplace, UK**

Software consultant **remote, from 06-2023 to 06-2023**

Scaffolding of the MVP for a contractee team.

- Worked with business to define domain & map it to the database and GraphQL API design.
- Set up CI and toolchain for backend development & testing.

One-month contract. Haven't extended because of a more permanent proposition from SwingDev.

TypeScript Node NestJS PostgreSQL GraphQL Prisma Heroku Clerk

Point of contact for references: Martin Richter, CTO

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Ownplay Inc. **startup, mobile game, USA**

Software consultant **remote, from 11-2022 to 06-2023**

- Created backoffice APIs, React-based SPA admin panels, and part of analytics for a mobile game, and its web-based prototype
- Built infrastructure for testing, and convinced the team to adopt the same approach for the rest of the project
- Coached junior developers

The contract was cut short because the company pivoted. In March 2024 I received an offer to jump back onboard.

TypeScript Node NestJS PostgreSQL REST+OpenAPI React Redux

Point of contact for references: Alexander Ovchinnikov, CTO

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Aterian **NASDAQ: ATER, e-commerce/logistic/ML company, USA**

Backend developer **hybrid, from 11-2020 to 11-2022**

Greenfield project, layered architecture, CQRS, DDD, TDD.

- We built from scratch a working multi-tenant affiliate platform on top of the Amazon Attribution program, before appropriate APIs were even available and backoffice for parts of the process that could not be automated
- Built a BDD-like domain-specific testing solution allowing for fast writing human-readable integration/E2E tests, as our need for safety outgrew what we could get away with during prototyping, before the onboarding of the first paying and getting-paid customers
- In addition to backend/domain work, I've set up our frontend architecture, which provided a Stimulus-like experience for our frontend developers, after we decided against a SPA frontend
- Performed some light DevOps and security-hardening tasks

PHP Symfony PostgreSQL TypeScript Vagrant Jenkins GitHub Ansible Terraform Azure

Point of contact for references: Jakub Włodek, Team Leader

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Dogadamycie sp. z o.o. translation company, PL

Full stack developer remote, from 01-2019 to 10-2020

- Led the process of bringing in-house previously outsourced software
- Built Docker and GitLab-based CI for the company
- Offloaded long-running workloads to queue
- Introduced automated testing
- Unified seven different customer panels into one project—maintenance and QA were killing us
- Greatly improved UX of the customer journey and automatic valuation process
- Integrated multiple payment systems and CAT software

PHP Laravel PostgreSQL Redis JavaScript JQuery GitLab Docker

Point of contact for references available on request: Robert Siemiński, CTO

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Joymile startup, middleman for used cars, PL

Full stack developer onsite, from 04-2018 to 01-2019

- I convinced my - now friends - then acquaintances to employ a mostly-PHP and JavaScript developer to do Python. They didn't regret this decision. A month later I was contributing on par with my peers.
- Moved legacy PHP supporting systems and almost 3 years' worth of data to our main Python-based infrastructure
- We built a mostly React-based customer journey that provided both great UX and gathered every possible bit of data that could help our sales, which we fed to our CRM and marketing automation

Company dissolved, as we were unable to secure another round of financing.

Python Django PostgreSQL Redis Kafka GraphQL JavaScript Node React Redux Docker

Point of contact for references: Wojciech Frycz, CTO

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Gremi Media SA publisher of "Rzeczpospolita" and rp.pl, PL

Technical Architect onsite, from 09-2016 to 03-2018

Team Leader onsite, from 04-2016 to 08-2016

Senior Web Developer onsite, from 10-2015 to 03-2016

Business impact

- Added millions of missing pieces of content—lost after previous CMS migration—back to search engines' index
- Removed discrepancies in our analytics falsifying traffic reports
- Improved uptime/availability of our main property from around 97.6% to 99.4%
- Improved loading times for our customers and their consistency by an order of magnitude
- Reworked our advertising system to allow new ad formats and better experience for our customers
- The whole process improved our traffic and unique users numbers by around one third

Technical impact

- Migrated the company from FTP deployment and SVN to Git and on-premises GitLab for the deployment process
- Banned FTP access to production. I built and maintained GIT<->SVN bridge for the transition period
- Understood, fixed our implementation and documented a badly misused and misunderstood caching system
- Introduced automated testing and proper telemetry
- Increased template and code reuse by orders of magnitude
- Replaced an assorted collection of PHP 5.2.17 (version enforced by vendor) scripts augmenting our legacy CMS, by self-built Symfony-inspired light framework enabling us to introduce automated testing and creation of Vagrant-based local environments for developers
- Replaced template-embedded frontend scripts with a proper build process and React-based components

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Archeotech PHP Symfony JavaScript Node JQuery React Vagrant GitLab Shell

Point of contact for references available on request: Tomasz Witkowski, Director of IT

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Uwazaj.pl **startup, a middleman between lawyers and customers, PL**

Full stack developer **remote, from 05-2015 to 05-2017**

- Took over after the software house failed to deliver both in terms of features and quality and built our product from scratch just in time to meet our investor's roadmap
- Built a visual "no-code" landing page builder for our marketing with A/B testing capabilities, adapted to manage the whole website by our non-technical staff
- Integrated content-marketing/sales part with our custom CRM and call center
- Set up our payment system
- Supported the project during its lifetime as a sole developer/ops engineer

PHP JavaScript JQuery WordPress Gulp Foundation SASS

Point of contact for references available on request: Dariusz Koltko, CEO

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Idium AS/Idium Kraków Sp. z o.o **website-as-service company, NO/PL**

Junior PHP Developer **onsite, from 05-2014 to 01-2015**

Senior WordPress Consultant **onsite, from 01-2014 to 04-2014**

- As a team, we built and maintained a framework allowing for ultra-fast delivery of customized, feature-complete WordPress websites for Scandinavian businesses
- Built an internal application automating the generation of SEO reports used by our sales team
- Took part in cleanup and hardening efforts after two separate security incidents

PHP WordPress JavaScript Shell

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Assorted freelance contracts

Web developer **remote, from 01-2011 to 06-2015**

Building, adding features, and maintaining various websites, WordPress plugins, and themes.

Occasional migration from Joomla or custom solutions to WordPress.

PHP WordPress WooCommerce JavaScript SASS/LESS Gulp/Grunt

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Internet media

Journalist, editor, and blogger **remote, from 10-2007 to 06-2012**

Writing for multiple internet media entities, including o2 sp. z o.o. *(currently: Grupa Wirtualna Polska)*, Antyweb and the Polish edition of PC World Computer about IT-related and unrelated topics.

Working as an editor/managing editor in two big blog networks.

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